SECTION 6 – Strategic Growth Area (SGA) Zones

The Strategic Growth Area Zones apply to lands designated Strategic Growth Area A, Strategic Growth Area B, and Strategic Growth Area C in the City of Kitchener Official Plan.

6.1 APPLICABLE ZONES

SGA-1: Strategic Growth Area One Zone – the purpose of this zone is to create opportunities for missing middle housing and compatible non-residential *uses* in low-rise forms up to 11 metres in height. This *zone* applies to lands designated Strategic Growth Area A in the City of Kitchener Official Plan.

SGA-2: Strategic Growth Area Two Zone – the purpose of this *zone* is to create opportunities for moderate growth in mid-rise forms up to 8 *storeys* in height. The SGA-2 zone will permit a mix of residential and non-residential *uses*. This *zone* applies to lands designated Strategic Growth Area A or Strategic Growth Area B in the City of Kitchener Official Plan.

SGA-3: Strategic Growth Area Three Zone – the purpose of this *zone* is to create opportunities for high-density growth in both mid and high-rise forms up to 28 *storeys* in height. The SGA-3 *zone* will permit a wide mix of residential and non-residential *uses*. This *zone* applies to lands designated Strategic Growth Area B or Strategic Growth Area C in the City of Kitchener Official Plan.

SGA-4: Strategic Growth Area Four Zone – the purpose of this *zone* is to create opportunities for high-density growth in both mid and high-rise forms. The SGA-4 zone will permit a wide mix of residential and non-residential *uses*. This zone applies to lands designated Strategic Growth Area C in the City of Kitchener Official Plan.

(Amended: By-law 2025-125, S.17 – October 27, 2025)

6.2 PERMITTED USES

No person shall, within any Strategic Growth Area Zone *use* or permit the *use* of any *lot* or erect, alter or *use* any *building* or *structure* for any purpose other than those permitted *uses* within Table 6-1 below.

Table 6-1: Permitted Uses within the Strategic Growth Area Zones

(Amended: By-law 2025-125, S.18 – October 27, 2025)

Use	SGA-1	SGA-2	SGA-3	SGA-4
Residential Uses				
Additional Dwelling Unit (Attached (2)	✓	✓	✓(3)	
Additional Dwelling Unit (Detached) (2)	✓	✓	✓(3)	

Use	SGA-1	SGA-2	SGA-3	SGA-4
Dwelling unit	✓	✓	✓	✓
Hospice (1)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Large residential care facility (1)		✓	✓	✓
Lodging house (1)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Multiple dwelling	✓	✓	✓	✓
Semi-detached dwelling (2)	✓	✓(3)	(4)	
Single detached dwelling (2)	✓	✓(3)	(4)	
Small residential care facility (1)	✓	✓	✓	✓
Street townhouse dwelling (2)	✓	✓(3)	✓(7)	
Home Occupations				
Home occupation	(5)	(5)	(5)	(5)
Community Uses				
Adult education school		✓	✓	✓
Community facility	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cultural facility	✓	✓	✓	✓
Day care facility	✓	✓	✓	✓
Elementary school		✓	✓	✓
Hospital			✓	✓
Place of worship	✓	✓	✓	✓
Post-secondary school		✓	✓	✓
Secondary school		✓	✓	✓
Social service establishment	✓	✓	✓	✓
Commercial Uses				
Artisan's establishment	✓	✓	✓	✓

Use	SGA-1	SGA-2	SGA-3	SGA-4
Brewpub	✓(6)	✓	✓	✓
Catering services establishment		✓	✓	✓
Commercial entertainment		✓	✓	✓
Commercial parking facility		✓	✓	✓
Commercial school	✓	✓	✓	✓
Conference, convention, or exhibition Facility			✓	✓
Craftsperson shop	✓	✓	✓	✓
Financial establishment		✓	✓	✓
Fitness centre	✓	✓	✓	✓
Health clinic	✓(6)	✓	✓	✓
Hotel		✓	✓	✓
Light repair operation	✓	✓	✓	✓
Office	✓	✓	✓	✓
Payday loan establishment		✓	✓	✓
Pawn establishment		✓	✓	✓
Personal services	✓	✓	✓	✓
Pet services establishment	✓	✓	✓	✓
Print shop	✓	✓	✓	✓
Restaurant	✓(6)	✓	✓	✓
Retail	✓	✓	✓	✓
Veterinary services	✓(6)	✓	✓	✓
Creative Industry Uses				
Biotechnological establishment		✓	✓	✓
Computer, electronic, data processing or server establishment		✓	✓	✓

Use	SGA-1	SGA-2	SGA-3	SGA-4
Creative products manufacturing		✓	✓	✓
Research and development establishment		✓	✓	✓

Additional Regulations for Permitted Uses Table 6-1

(1) Shall be in accordance with the regulations of the SGA *zone* and dwelling type in which the *lodging house*, *hospice*, or *large* or *small residential care facility* is located.

(2) Up to 4 *dwelling units* shall be permitted on a *lot* containing a *single detached dwelling*, *semi-detached dwelling unit*, or *street townhouse dwelling unit* in accordance with the regulations of Section 4.12.

(3) Shall only be permitted on a *lot* containing an *existing single detached dwelling*, *semi-detached dwelling*, or *street townhouse dwelling*.

(4) *New single detached dwellings* and *semi-detached dwellings* shall not be permitted. Additions and alterations to *existing dwellings* shall be permitted in accordance with Section 6.3.1, including allowing up to 4 units on a *lot*.

(5) Shall be permitted in accordance with Section 4.7 (Home Occupation).

(6) Shall only be permitted on *corner lots* and patios shall only be permitted in the *front* and *exterior side yard* in accordance with Section 4.14.8.1.

(7) Shall only be permitted on a *lot* containing a *multiple dwelling.*

6.3 SGA-1 ZONE REGULATIONS

6.3.1 Single Detached, Semi-Detached, and Street Townhouse Dwelling Units

a) Table 6-2 applies to *single detached dwellings*, *semi-detached dwelling units*, and *street townhouse dwelling units*.

b) The regulations within Table 6-2 shall not apply to *existing buildings* or *structures*.

Table 6-2: Single Detached, Semi-Detached, and Street Townhouse Dwelling Units

Regulation	Single Detached Dwelling	Semi-Detached Dwelling unit	Street Townhouse Dwelling unit
Minimum *lot area*	235m^2	210m^2	135m^2
Minimum *lot width* (internal unit)	n/a	n/a	5.5m
Minimum *lot width* (external unit)	n/a	n/a	8.5m
Minimum *lot width*	9.0m	7.5m	n/a

Minimum *corner lot width*	12.8m	12.0m	11.5m
Minimum *interior side yard setback*	1.2m	1.2m	2.5m
Minimum *front yard* or *exterior side yard setback*	4.5m(1)(2)	4.5m(1)(2)	4.5m(1)
Minimum *rear yard setback*	7.5m	7.5m	7.5m
Maximum *lot coverage*	55%(3)	55%(3)	55%(3)
Maximum *building height*	11.0m	11.0m	11.0m
Maximum number of *storeys*	3	3	3
Rear yard access	n/a	n/a	(4)

Additional Regulations for Table 6-2

(1) For an addition to an *existing dwelling* or demolition and replacement of an *existing dwelling*, the *existing front* and/or *exterior side yard setbacks* may be used as the minimum requirement.

(2) No part of any *building* used to accommodate off street parking shall be located closer than 6 metres to the *street line*.

(3) A combined total of 55 percent for all *buildings* and *structures* on the *lot*. *Accessory buildings* or *structures*, whether attached or detached, and *additional dwelling detached)* shall not exceed 15 percent. (Amended: By-law 2025-125, S.20 – October 27, 2025)

(4) Each *dwelling unit* shall have an unobstructed access at *grade* or ground floor level, having a minimum width of 0.9 metres, from the *front yard* to the *rear yard* of the *lot* either by:

a) direct access on the *lot* without passing through any portion of the *dwelling unit*; or,

b) direct access through the dwelling unit without passing through a living or family room, dining room, kitchen, bathroom, bedroom, or recreation room or any hallway that is not separated by a door to any such room; or

c) access over adjacent lands which, if the lands are not owned by the City or the Region, is secured by a registered easement.

6.3.2 Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings

a) Table 6-3 applies to:

i. *Multiple dwellings*;

ii. *Mixed use buildings*; and,

iii. Non-residential *buildings*.

b) The regulations within Table 6-3 shall not apply to *existing buildings* and *structures*.

c) *Existing buildings* may be converted to the following, subject only to the applicable minimum *lot width*, minimum *lot area*, *parking spaces* on a *driveway* in the *front* and *exterior side yard*, and maximum non-residential *gross floor area* of Table 6-3:

i. a *multiple dwelling* with 5 or more *dwelling units*; (Amended: By-law 2025-125, S.21 – October 27, 2025)

ii. a *mixed use building* containing 1 or more *dwelling units*; and,

iii. a non-residential *building*.

Table 6-3: Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings

(Amended: By-law 2025-125, S.24 – October 27, 2025)

Regulation	**Number of dwelling units**			**Non-Residential Building**
	(1)	**5-10**	**11+**	
Minimum *lot width*	12.0m	12.0m	18.0m	15.0m
Minimum *lot area*	350m^2	450m^2	700m^2	600m^2
Minimum *front yard setback*	4.5m	4.5m	4.5m	4.5m
Parking spaces on a *driveway* in the *front* and/or *exterior side yard*	(2)	(2)	(2)	n/a
Minimum *exterior side yard setback*	4.0m	4.0m	4.0m	4.0m
Minimum *rear yard setback*	7.5m	7.5m	7.5m	7.5m
Minimum *interior side yard setback* A (4)	1.5m	1.5m	2.5m	2.5m
Minimum *interior side yard setback* B (4)	2.5m	2.5m	2.5m	2.5m

Minimum *floor space ratio*	n/a	n/a	0.6	0.6
Maximum *building height*	11.0m	11.0m	11.0m	11.0m
Maximum *building* length	20.0m	24.0m	36.0m	36.0m
Minimum *street line façade openings*	20%	20%	20%	20%
Minimum *landscaped area*	30%	30%	30%	30%
Minimum *rear yard landscaped area*	40%	40%	40%	40%
Maximum non-residential *gross floor area* (3)	$100m^2$	$150m^2$	$200m^2$	200m2

Additional Regulations for Table 6-3

(1) Shall apply to a *mixed use building* containing 1-4 *dwelling units*.

(2) Despite Section 5.3.3 b) i), *parking spaces* may be provided in the *front* and *exterior side yard*, provided they are located on a *driveway* that conforms with regulations of Section 5.4 and Table 5-2 for *single detached dwelling*. No additional regulations shall apply for a *lot* identified on Appendix C – Central Neighbourhoods. *Parking spaces* may be located on a *driveway*.

(3) Non-residential *gross floor area s*hall not be permitted in a detached *accessory building* or *structure*.

(4) For properties that have 2 or more i*nterior side lot lines* intersecting with a *street line*, at least 1 *interior side lot line* intersecting with a *street line* shall meet the minimum *interior side yard setback* B. For properties with only one i*nterior side lot line* intersecting with a *street line*, *minimum interior side yard setback* A shall apply.

6.4 SGA-2 ZONE REGULATIONS

6.4.1 Single Detached, Semi-Detached, and Street Townhouse Dwellings

a) For *single detached dwellings*, *semi-detached dwelling units*, and *street townhouse dwelling units*, refer to Section 6.3.1 for regulations.

6.4.2 Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings up to 4 Storeys in Height

a) For *multiple dwellings* up to 4 *storeys* in height, *mixed use buildings* up to 4 *storeys* in height, and non-residential *buildings* up to 4 *storeys* in height, refer to Section 6.3.2 for regulations.

b) Further to subsection a), these *buildings* may exceed the maximum *building height,* maximum number of *storeys*, and maximum non-residential *gross floor area* within Table 6-3.

6.4.3 MULTIPLE DWELLINGS, MIXED USE BUILDINGS, AND NON-RESIDENTIAL BUILDINGS

a) Table 6-4 applies to:

i. *Multiple dwellings* 5 *storeys* and greater;

ii. *Mixed use buildings* 5 *storeys* and greater; and,

iii. Non-residential *buildings* 5 *storeys* and greater.

b) The regulations within Table 6-4 shall not apply to existing *buildings* or *structures*.

Table 6-4: Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings

Regulation	SGA-2
For Entire Building	
Minimum *lot width*	30.0m(1)
Minimum *lot area*	1,500m^2
Minimum *yard setback*	3.0m
Minimum *floor space ratio*	1.0
Maximum *building height*	8 storeys
Minimum *façade openings*	10%
Minimum *street line façade openings*	20%
Minimum landscape area	20%(2)
For Storeys 7 and Above	
Minimum *yard setback*	6.0m
Maximum *building* length	60.0m
Maximum *floor plate area*	2,000m^2
Transition to Low Rise Zones	
Maximum *building height* within 15m of a *lot* with an SGA-1 *zone* or a *lot* with a *low-rise residential zone*	20.0m(3)
Minimum *yard setback* where the *lot* abuts a *lot* with an SGA-1 *zone* or a *low-rise residential zone*	7.5m
For Lot Lines Abutting a Priority Street Identified on Appendix G	

Refer to Section 6.6 for additional regulations.
Private Amenity Space Requirements
Refer to Section 6.7 – Private Amenity Space.

Additional Regulations for Table 6-4

(1) Despite Section 3, for a *lot* with more than one *street line*, minimum *lot width* may be measured from the longest *lot line* abutting a *street*.

(2) The requirement for a *lot* abutting a Priority Street segment identified on Appendix G shall be 0%.

(3) Despite Section 4.19, this regulation shall apply (Transition to Low-Rise Zones).

6.5 SGA-3 AND SGA-4 ZONE REGULATIONS

Street Townhouse Dwellings

a) For *street townhouse dwelling units*, refer to Section 6.3.1 for regulations.

6.5.1 Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings up to 4 Storeys in Height

a) For *multiple dwellings* up to 4 *storeys* in height, *mixed use buildings* up to 4 *storeys* in height, and non-residential *buildings* up to 4 *storeys* in height, refer to Section 6.3.2 for regulations.

b) Further to subsection a), these *buildings* may exceed the maximum *building height*, maximum number of *storeys*, and maximum non-residential *gross floor area* within Table 6-3.

6.5.2 Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings

a) Table 6-5 applies to:

i. *Multiple dwellings* 5 storeys and greater;

ii. *Mixed use buildings* 5 storeys and greater; and,

iii. Non-residential *buildings* 5 *storeys* and greater.

b) The regulations within Table 6-5 shall not apply to *existing buildings* or *structures*.

Table 6-5: Multiple Dwellings, Mixed Use Buildings, and Non-Residential Buildings

Regulation	**SGA-3 & SGA-4**
For Entire Building	
Minimum *lot width*	30.0m(1)
Minimum *lot area*	1,500m^2
Minimum *yard setback*	3.0m
Minimum *building base* height	3 storeys
Maximum *building base* height	6 storeys
Minimum *floor space ratio* (5)	2.0
Maximum *building height* in the SGA-3 *zone*	28 *storeys*
Minimum *street line ground floor building height*	4.5m
Minimum *façade openings*	10%
Minimum *street line façade openings*	20%
For Storeys 7-12	
Minimum *lot width*	30.0m
Minimum *lot area*	1,500m^2
Minimum *front* and *exterior side yard setback*	6.0m
Maximum *building* length	60.0m(3)
Maximum *floor plate area*	2,000m^2(4)
Physical separation	6.0m
For Storeys 13-18	
Minimum *lot width*	36.0m
Minimum *lot area*	1,800m^2
Minimum *front* and *exterior side yard setback*	6.0m
Maximum *building* length	54.0m
Maximum *floor plate area*	1,200m^2
Physical separation	9.0m
For Storeys 19-36	

Minimum *lot width*	42.0m
Minimum *lot area*	2,000m^2,
Minimum *front* and *exterior side yard setback*	6.0m
Maximum *building* length	48.0m
Maximum *floor plate area*	1,000m^2
Physical separation	12.0m
For Storeys 37 and Above	
Minimum *lot width*	48.0m
Minimum *lot area*	2,400m^2
Minimum *front* and *exterior side yard setback*	6.0m
Maximum *building* length	42.0m
Maximum floor plate area	900m^2
Physical separation	15.0m
Transition to Low Rise Zones	
Maximum *building height* within 15m of a *lot* with an SGA-1 *zone* or a *lot* with a *low-rise residential zone*	20.0m(2)
Maximum *building height* within 30m of a *lot* with an SGA-1 *zone* or a *lot* with a *low-rise residential zone*	30.0m(2)
Minimum *yard setback* where the *lot* abuts a *lot* with an SGA-1 *zone* or a *low-rise residential zone*	7.5m
For Lot Lines Abutting a Priority Street Identified on Appendix G	
Refer to Section 6.6 – Priority Streets.	
Private Amenity Space Requirements	
Refer to Section 6.7 – Private Amenity Space.	

Additional Regulations for Table 6-5

(1) For a *lot* with more than one *street line*, minimum *lot width* may be measured from the longest *lot line* abutting a *street*.

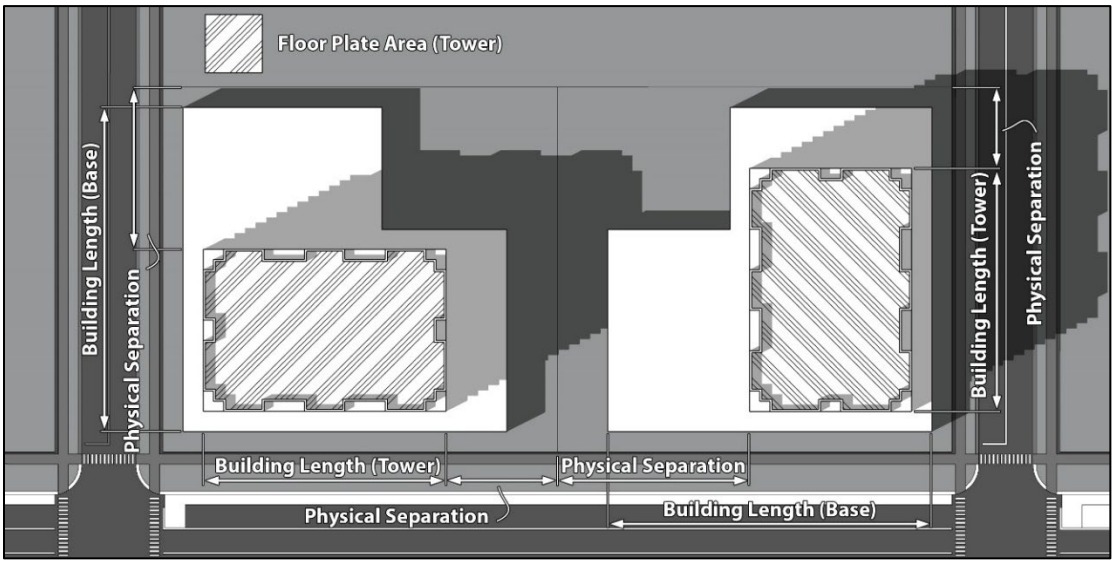
(2) Despite *Section 4.19,* this regulation shall apply (Transition to Low-Rise Zones).

(3) Where a *building* does not exceed 12 storeys in height, the maximum *building length* shall be 70m.

(4) Where a *building* does not exceed 12 storeys in height, the maximum *floor plate area* shall be 2,800m^2.

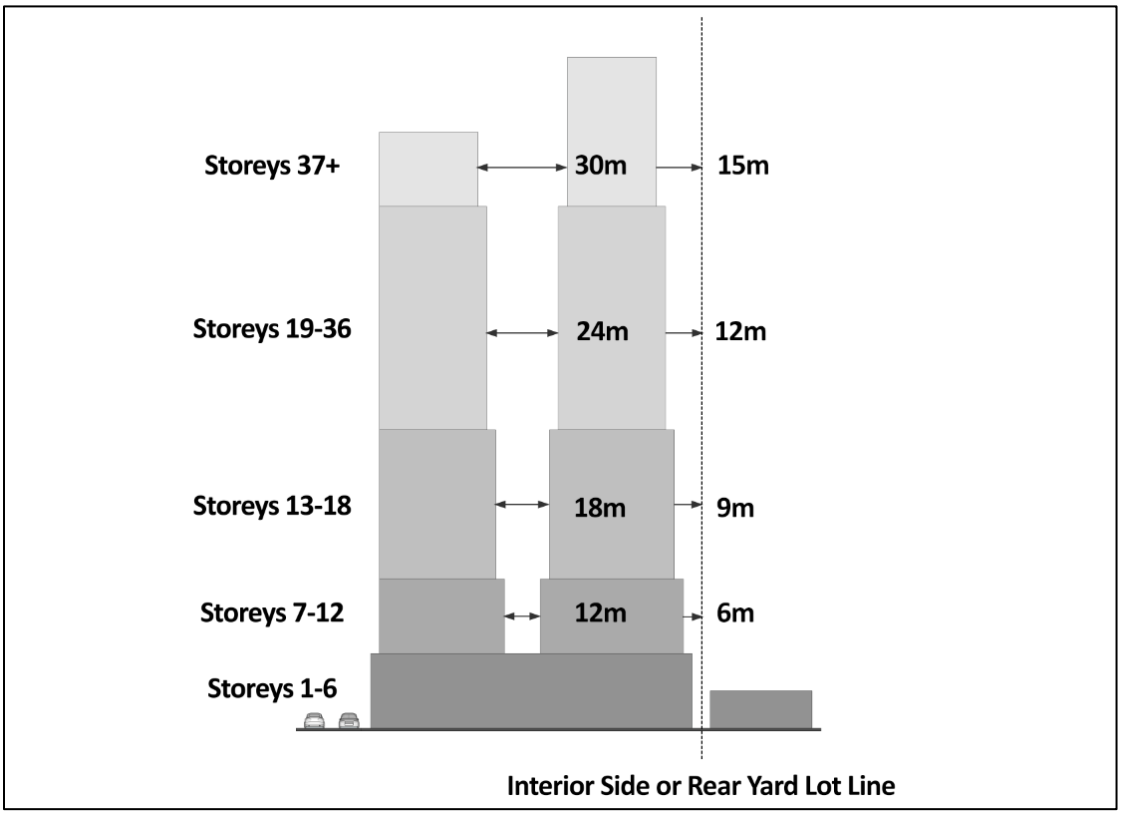
(5) Where the *lot area* is 2.0 hectares or greater, this regulation shall not apply within the Fairway and Sportsworld Protected Major Transit Station Areas as shown in Appendix F of this By-law. (Amended: By-law 2025-049, S.3 – May 5, 2025)

Illustration 6-1: Physical Separation, Building Length, and Floor Plate Area



This diagram demonstrates in plan how the built form regulations are generally applied. For illustrative purposes only.

Illustration 6-2: Physical Separation



This diagram demonstrates in elevation how the physical separation regulation is generally applied. For illustrative purposes only.

6.6 PRIORITY STREETS

a) For *lot lines* abutting *street line* segments identified on Appendix G – Priority Streets, the following shall apply:

i. a Community Use or Commercial Use listed in Table 6-1 shall occupy a minimum of 50% of the *street line ground floor*, excluding *office* and *commercial parking facility*;

ii. above *grade* structured *parking spaces* shall not be permitted along the *street line ground floor* or *street line* second floor, except for access;

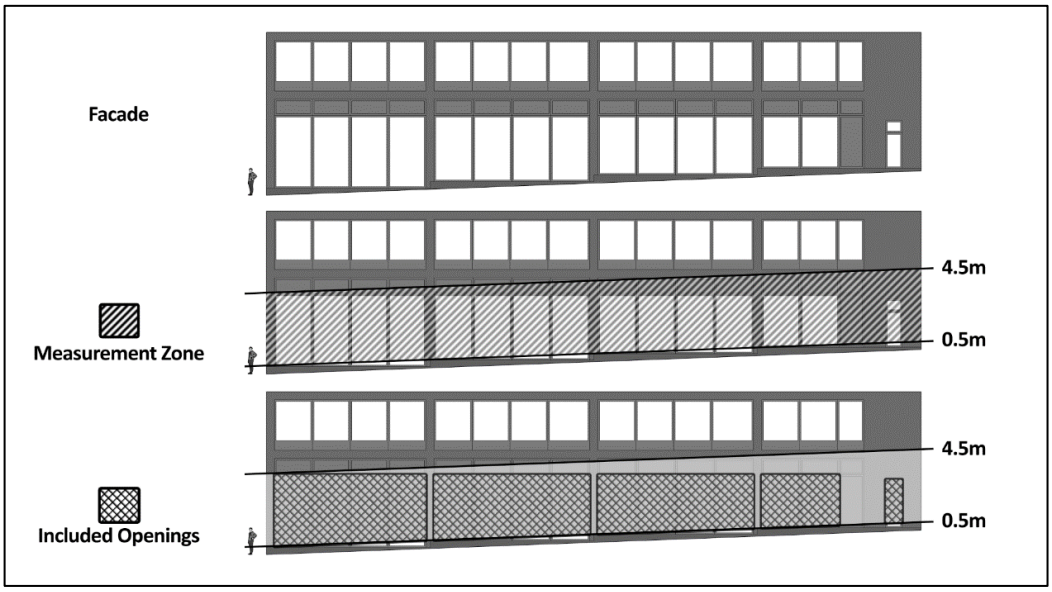
iii. above *grade* structured *parking spaces* shall not occupy more than 50% of the area of the *street line façade* within the *base* of a *building*;

iv. surface *parking spaces* shall not be permitted within 6 metres of the *street line*;

v. on *lots* zoned SGA-2, the minimum *street line ground floor building height* shall be 4.5 metres. The requirement for *lots* zoned SGA-3 and SGA-4 shall be in accordance with Table 6-5;

vi. the minimum *street line ground floor façade openings* shall be 40%, measured between 0.5m and 4.5m above exterior finished *grade* along the entire width of the *street line façade*;

Illustration 6-3: Street Line Façade Openings Measurement



This diagram demonstrates in elevation how façade openings are measured. For illustrative purposes only.

vii. for *storeys* 1-6, the minimum *interior side yard setback* shall be 0m; and,

viii. for *storeys* 2-6, the minimum *front* and *exterior side yard* shall be 0m;

6.7 PRIVATE AMENITY SPACE

a) *Amenity space* shall be required as follows:

i. In an SGA-2 *zone*, 4m^2 of *amenity space* is required per *dwelling unit*; and,

ii. In an SGA-3 and SGA-4 *zone*, 8m^2 of *amenity space* is required per *dwelling unit*.

b) Further to subsection a), private amenity, where provided, may count towards *amenity space* requirements where they achieve:

i. A minimum depth of 1.2m; and,

ii. A minimum area of 4m^2 each, excluding area occupied by mechanical equipment such as air conditioning units.

c) Further to subsection a) ii., where private amenity space totals less than 3m^2 per unit, 5m^2 of common amenity space is required per *dwelling unit*.

6.8 OUTDOOR STORAGE

a) No *outdoor storage* shall be permitted. This shall not however prevent the display of goods for *retail* purposes.